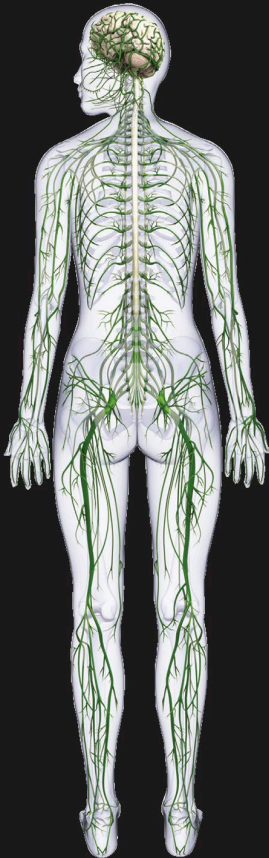


NERVOUS

EXPLORED ON PAGES 76–129

The brain is the seat of both consciousness and creativity and, through the spinal cord and nerve branches, it controls all body movements with its motor output. The brain also receives sensory information from outside and within the body. Much of the brain's activity occurs unconsciously as it works with endocrine glands to monitor and maintain other body systems.



ENDOCRINE

EXPLORED ON PAGES 130–143

The glands and cells of the endocrine system produce chemical messengers called hormones, which circulate in blood and other fluids. These maintain an optimal internal environment. Hormones also govern long-term processes such as growth, the changes that take place during puberty, and reproductive activity. The endocrine system has close links to the nervous system.



CARDIOVASCULAR

EXPLORED ON PAGES 144–159

The most basic function of the cardiovascular, or circulatory, system is to pump blood around the body. It supplies all organs and tissues with freshly oxygenated, nutrient-rich blood. Any waste products of cell function are removed with the blood as it leaves. The circulatory system also transports other vital substances, such as nutrients, hormones, and immune cells.

